

ASUS Vivobook S16

Good things come in slim packages

When I first laid eyes on the newly launched Asus Vivobook S16, powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon X processor, I paused for a moment just to admire how good it looks. While most laptops stick to predictable shades of black, grey, and silver, Asus has dared to try something different. The Vivobook S16 arrives in refreshing new colours – Salvia Green and BFF Peachy- and they instantly make the device feel modern, chic, and just plain desirable.

I received the Salvia Green variant for review and have been using it as my daily driver for nearly two weeks and I have been satisfied with the experience overall. The moment I pulled the laptop out of my bag on a Monday morning, I caught a few curious glances from colleagues. Now usually, laptops aren't meant to be conversation starters, but this one might just be.

With an MRP of Rs 98,990, the laptop is available at a launch price of Rs 67,990. And it looks custom-made for working professionals, students and anybody who needs a good-looking and easy to carry around laptop that comes with an impressive battery life. But before we delve deeper in the review, let's take a quick look at the top specifications of the device.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The Asus Vivobook S16's design is one of its strongest points. Asus believes that customers are looking for a colour pop when it comes to laptops so they introduced two new colours in a segment that is "dominated by blacks and silvers." And after spending a few days with the Vivobook S16, I feel that is true. Having a laptop in a colour

₹98,990



that's striking yet elegant feels refreshing.

The Salvia Green, in particular, has a calm, almost soothing vibe to it. Imagine looking out of your window on a rainy day and spotting lush greenery outside.

That's the kind of visual relief this colour brings in the middle of a busy workday. The finish is metallic and well-crafted too. It's not flashy but definitely stylish enough to stand out in an office, a café, or even during a client meeting.

At just 15.9mm and weighing around 1.74 kg, the laptop easily slipped into my backpack and was easy to carry everyday. I have to travel a long distance to commute to work and carrying around the Vivobook S16 wasn't a difficult task.

In terms of build quality, the laptop feels sturdy enough to handle daily wear and tear. During my usage, I didn't really notice any fingerprints forming up. When there is pressure on the chassis, there is minor flex but not concerning.

DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

Display is another area where the Vivobook S16 holds its ground. Asus claims that the display comes with a 95%

DCI-P3 color gamut. And that claim was true during our testing of the device.

On the colour accuracy front, the device showed an average DeltaE of 1.4 which is a strong result, putting it well within professional-grade territory where anything under 2 is considered excellent. Even in the worst-case scenario, the max DeltaE was 6.7, which isn't something you'd notice while watching content or editing photos. Simply put, you can trust the laptop's colour reproduction.

Talking about brightness, the Lux meter showed a peak brightness of 300 nits which makes the laptop more than adequate to be used comfortably outdoors. I used the laptop to work out of a cab while commuting to work on a rainy day and the display was bright enough. I actually had to turn the brightness down by two points to avoid straining my eyes.

With that being said, since this is an OLED display, it has a glossy finish. And in office lights, this can prove to be a bit of a challenge. I constantly had to adjust the positioning of my screen to avoid a strong glare from the lights behind me. The 60Hz refresh rate is another factor that raises eyebrows. But if you are going to use the laptop for work purposes, it won't make a big difference.

In terms of speakers, the laptop offers a decent experience. The audio was loud enough to be heard clearly in an office environment. There isn't a groundbreaking bass level here, but you don't expect that from a productivity device. It is, however, more than enough for casual content viewing.

PERFORMANCE AND AI

Powered by the Snapdragon X 126 100 processor, the Vivobook S16 is for those who want a device that is built to last on a busy work day. The apps launch at a lightning fast speed on the device, I could comfortably work with at least 20 tabs open, and didn't experience any lags. The laptop also remained quite cool, even under sustained workloads.

The performance is backed up with benchmark test scores, which aren't the